

What a screen reader misses on a food producer's website

A short accessibility check against WCAG 2.1 AA · 11 September 2026

I looked at the main site, the careers pages, the English section and the member portal.

Sample copy. The organisation's name, its brands, its file names and its class names have been taken out. The findings, the measurements and the fixes are as they were sent.

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One set of notes from a series, written for the organisation and sent to it with its name on: **five notes, each with the fix written next to it.**

FIRST, WHAT ALREADY WORKS

- Colour is not a problem anywhere I measured. **175 measurements across the front page and the careers page, against the composed background, with no failure.** The lowest reading on either page is the same element, the footer heading «Kontakt» at **7.45:1**, which is well past what AA asks for. Three measurements on the front page sit on a photograph and I left them out, because a script cannot read those.
- Every one of the **24 images on those two pages carries an alt attribute**, and none is missing one. Zoom is not blocked: the viewport tag sets an initial scale and stops there. Both pages **reflow at 320 pixels with no horizontal scrolling**, which is the width of the smallest phone still in use.
- The browser's own focus ring is intact. I went through the header with the Tab key and every link and button I landed on showed it, on the navy bar at **6.45:1** against the background. Most sites lose this by accident. Yours has it, and note 3 is the one place where a rule takes it away.

What fails is not colour or alt text. It is the structure underneath: what a control is called, and what counts as a heading. What follows is four specific problems and one judgement call. Three of the four are three components, and one of those components is on two of your sites.

2.4.4 Link Purpose Level A

4.1.2 Name, Role, Value Level A

1. Ten links on the careers page have no name, so a screen reader reads out the address

```
<div class="card">
  <a href="/careers/apprentices">
    <div class="card__image"><img src="" alt=""></div>
  </a>
</div>
<div class="card__content">
  <h3 class="card__heading">Lærlinger</h3>
```

← the entire link is one image, and its alt is empty

← the words are here, outside the link

WHAT I SAW	On the careers page, 12 of the 67 visible controls have no accessible name, and ten of them are the same component , the card. The link holds one image with an empty alt and no text, and the words that say where it goes sit in the <code>h3</code> beside it, outside the link. On the front page it is 5 of 61, four of them that same card. The other two on the careers page are the logo in the header , where the <code>aria-label</code> is on a <code></code> that has no role and therefore names nothing, and the first breadcrumb, which contains one space.
THE EFFECT	With no name, the browser falls back to the address. Someone listening to your careers page hears the URL spelled out in fragments where you wrote «Lærlinger». Each card then offers a second link to the same page, called «Les mer», so every destination is announced twice: once as an address, once as two words that do not say where they lead. Pulled up as a list of links, which is how a lot of people move through a page they do not know, the careers page offers ten addresses and ten «Les mer».
THE FIX	Put the link around the heading text and leave the picture decorative, so each card is one link with a name. The empty alt is right for the image. One component, and the same card is on the member portal.

1.3.1 Info and Relationships Level A

2. The text under each card title is marked up as a heading, so half the outline is body copy

```
<h3 class="card__heading">Lærlinger</h3>
<h5 class="card__preface">
  <p>[the first sentence of the card's preface]</p>
  <p>Som lærling har du mange muligheter!</p>
</h5>
```

The careers page, every visible heading: h1 x1 h2 x0 h3 x12 h4 x3 h5 x11

WHAT I SAW	The card's preface is an <code><h5></code> with paragraphs inside it. On the careers page that happens eleven times, and the page has no second-level heading at all . The front page runs 1, 3, 5, 3, 5 the whole way down and reaches a 2 near the bottom. The same component is on the member portal, where five prefaces are marked up the same way, and one of them is the phone number and the email address for the member service.
THE EFFECT	The list of headings is the table of contents people navigate by, and half of this one is body copy. Someone moving heading to heading through your careers page hears «Lærlinger», then hears a full sentence announced as a heading two levels below it, and has to listen to the end to find out it was a sentence from the paragraph. The levels also say something that is not true: that the description is a sub-section of the title above it, with two levels missing in between.
THE FIX	<code><p class="card__preface"></code> . The class already carries the size and the colour, so nothing changes on screen. One component, two sites.

2.4.7 Focus Visible Level AA

3. On the page where the IT department recruits, the accordion takes focus with nothing to show for it

```
.accordion__trigger { background-color: rgb(242, 242, 242); border-style: none;
  border-radius: 7px; color: rgb(0, 32, 91); cursor: pointer; display: block;
  outline: none; padding: 0; text-align: left; width: 100% }

.accordion__trigger--open, .accordion__trigger:hover { background-color: #fff }
← a :hover rule, and no :focus rule anywhere
```

WHAT I SAW	The widget is built the way the pattern is supposed to be built. The trigger is a real <code><button></code> , <code>aria-expanded</code> flips, and <code>aria-controls</code> points at a panel that is <code>hidden</code> when closed and carries a region role. The one thing missing is the ring. I tabbed onto it and then compared the computed styles of the button, its label and its two parents with focus and without: outline, box-shadow, background, colour, border, text decoration. Nothing differs. Six buttons on that page.
THE EFFECT	A person on the keyboard cannot see where they are, and the panels only open on Enter or Space, so they are pressing keys at a target they cannot see. Behind those six buttons are the answers to what a developer's day at the company looks like, which technologies you use, how large the teams are and what the office is like. It is the page that recruits the people who would fix it.
THE FIX	Take <code>outline: none</code> out of that one rule. The ring the rest of the site uses is the browser's own, and it comes back the moment nothing removes it. One line.

3.1.1 Language of Page Level A

4. Every page of the English section declares that it is written in Norwegian

```

/english                <html lang="no">
/english/products/[a product] <html lang="no">
/english/about/...      <html lang="no">

"[The company's description of itself, in English.]"

```

WHAT I SAW	The section under <code>/english</code> is in English: the annual reports back to 2019, the two pages about the company, nine product pages, nineteen pages in all . The document language on every one of them is <code>no</code> , and nothing below the <code><html></code> element overrides it. The code itself is correct for Norwegian. It is the wrong language for these pages.
THE EFFECT	A screen reader takes its voice and its pronunciation rules from that attribute, so English sentences are read out with Norwegian rules and the listener decodes them word by word. The people reading the English pages are the ones least likely to have a Norwegian voice installed , and this is the section a foreign buyer, a journalist or a customer abroad reads first.
THE FIX	<code>lang="en"</code> wherever the CMS sets the language for that section. The footer on those pages stays in Norwegian, so it takes a <code>lang="no"</code> of its own. One template, nineteen pages.

Landmarks A judgement call, not a failure

5. There is no main landmark anywhere, and the main site has no skip link

```

the main site      <div class="main-container">          no skip link on the page
the member portal  <section class="main-container">

the member portal, first thing in the tab order:
<a href="#main-container">Hopp til innholdet</a>

```

WHAT I SAW	None of the pages I opened has a <code><main></code> . The wrapper is called <code>main-container</code> on all of them, and it is a <code>div</code> on the main site and a <code>section</code> on the member portal. The main site has no skip link either: the first Tab from the top of the page lands on «For bedrifter» in the grey bar, and the only in-page anchor is the cookie settings link. Your member portal already has the skip link, «Hopp til innholdet», pointing at that same wrapper.
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MY VIEW	I am not reporting this as a failure, because it is not one. Bypassing repeated blocks can be satisfied several ways, and two of them are landmarks and a heading at the start of each section. You have a banner, a navigation and a footer, and every section carries a heading, so the criterion is met. What that leaves standing is the reason I am writing it down: the mechanism carrying it is the list of headings, and that list is note 2. Until note 2 is fixed, the practical route into the content of the main site is eighteen Tab presses through the header.
THE FIX	A <code><main></code> on the element already named <code>main-container</code> , and the skip link your member portal already has. The pattern to copy is your own.

WHAT THE REGULATIONS REQUIRE

WCAG 2.1 levels A and AA are a legal requirement for private organisations in Norway under the regulations on universal design of ICT, which hold you to **35 of the criteria**. The European Accessibility Act is on its way into Norwegian law.

Notes 1 to 4 are failures against those criteria. Note 5 is not, and I have marked it as what it is. Two more things are on my list and not written up here: the logo link in the header, which has no accessible name on any page for the reason in note 1, and the panel of each accordion, whose `aria-labelledby` points at `accordion_btn_`, an id with the number missing. Three things I did not check: **a run with a real screen reader**, the trade portal, and anything behind a login.

AREAS OF WORK

The part of universal design that lives in the component library

Three of the four failures are three components: the card, the accordion trigger and the page header. None of them is a mistake anybody made twice. They are decisions taken once, in one place, that then went out everywhere, which is also why each one is a single job. The card is worth the most, because **the same card is on the main site and on the member portal, so one change reaches a consumer and a member at the same time.** Your own job adverts name a design system. The work here is naming who owns a component's accessibility and giving that person a list short enough to act on.

Four audiences, one library

Your digital surfaces do not share a reader. A member opens the member portal early in the morning, a school office orders on the ordering service, a buyer works in the trade portal, someone with a pan on the hob reads the recipe site. They share components. **A building is the same problem: one entrance for visitors, one for deliveries, one for staff, and a single set of decisions about light, thresholds and signs that has to hold for all three.** I trained as an architect and moved into digital work, and that is the drawing I know how to make.

This is a view from outside, and a starting list. The rest of what I have done is in the CV.

ABOUT THIS COPY

The organisation received this document with its name on it.

This is one of a series of notes written between August and September 2026 for Norwegian organisations. The name, the brands, the file names and the class names have been taken out; the findings, the measurements and the fixes are as they were sent. What the series had in common is at wioletawojcik.com/accessibility.html.